

the image sensor, near the focal plane of the lens. The focal plane shutter is made of two opaque *curtains* placed over the sensor slightly apart.

### Electronic Shutters:

Electronic shutters precisely control the time for a particular exposure according to the duration set. In the case of electronic shutters, the data that the image sensor has stored up for a particular image is wiped clean and the sensor then becomes like a new panel in a photographic film – fresh and ready to collect light again using the electronic shutter.

### Shutter Speeds

The time duration that a shutter stays open is called *Shutter Speed* – a.k.a. *Exposure Time*. The better the camera, the wider range of shutter speeds it offers. Shutter speeds are measured in fractions of a second and while manufacturers earlier fixed their speed settings randomly, standardisation has made it a lot easier now.

The standard settings for shutter speeds are

- 1/1000 s
- 1/500 s
- 1/250 s
- 1/125 s
- 1/60 s
- 1/30 s
- 1/15 s
- 1/8 s
- 1/4 s
- 1/2 s
- 1 s

In low-light situations, you'll need a wider aperture and a longer exposure time – read a slower shutter speed. Very short shutter speeds are great for 'stop-action' pictures where you'd like to freeze fast-moving subjects, as in sports photography. But for normal shoots, the camera movement can blur photos if the shutter speed is too slow, making the image seem out of focus. It's virtually impossible to hold the camera absolutely still for long, so unless you have a tripod, a shutter speed of 1/500 with an aperture stop of  $f/8$  would give you a pretty neat